

This short text, known in English as *The Auspicious Verses of the Five* (with a

Toh 823 · Derge Kangyur

This short text, known in English as *The Auspicious Verses of the Five* (with a section titled *The Auspicious Verses of the Three Families*), is a devotional liturgical composition invoking blessings through homage to the Three Jewels and to a series of buddhas and bodhisattva protectors, including Mañjuśrī, Avalokiteśvara, and Vajrapāṇi, each likened to a majestic, colored mountain embodying the auspicious qualities of a Sugata's body, speech, and mind. Structured as a sequence of verses praising these enlightened figures and calling forth auspiciousness in the present moment, the work belongs to the genre of auspicious-verse (bkra shis tshigs bcad) liturgies recited for blessing and ceremonial purposes. Its Sanskrit title, if it existed, is not preserved in the available materials, though its Tibetan title can be reconstructed as bkra shis tshigs su bcad pa lnga pa or similar, reflecting its structure of five sets of auspicious verses. This text is catalogued as Toh 823 in the Kangyur, situating it among the shorter ritual and dedicatory verse compositions of that collection.

The auspicious verses of the five are complete.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

The auspicious verses of the three families.

The Blessed One, like a mountain king of golden hue,
Protector of the three worlds, the youthful form of Mañjuśrī—
Whatever auspiciousness belongs to the body of the Sugata (the "Well-Gone One," an epithet of a buddha),
By that auspiciousness may there be goodness and excellence here today.

The Blessed One, like a mountain king of conch-white hue,
Protector of the three worlds, Lord Avalokiteśvara—
Whatever auspiciousness belongs to the speech of the Sugata,
By that auspiciousness may there be goodness and excellence here today.

The Blessed One, like a mountain king of greenish-yellow hue,
Protector of the three worlds, Vajrapāṇi—
Whatever auspiciousness belongs to the mind of the Sugata,
By that auspiciousness too may there be goodness and excellence here today.

Translator's Notes

- The opening line ("The auspicious verses of the five are complete") appears to be the closing colophon of a preceding, separate text, after which this new prayer—"The Auspicious Verses of the Three Families," honoring Mañjuśrī, Avalokiteśvara, and Vajrapāṇi as embodiments of the buddhas' body, speech, and mind—begins. The unusual greenish-yellow color given for Vajrapāṇi (rather than the more common dark blue) is preserved as found in the source text.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.